



MEONCROSS SCHOOL | HISTORY DEPARTMENT

COMPLETE UNIT

*KS3: Medieval England & The Struggle for Power
(1066–1485)*



PROGRESS & ASSESSMENT TRACKER

Lesson / Assessment Title	Effort	Level	Teacher Comments
L1: Lesson 1: 1066 - Why did three men claim one throne, and how did William win?			
L2: Lesson 2: Castles, Terror, and the Domesday Book - How did William control England?			
L3: Lesson 3: Crown vs Church: Why did Henry II clash with Thomas Becket?			
L4: Lesson 4: Magna Carta (1215): A triumph of liberty or a selfish baronial power grab?			
L5: Lesson 5: Doom Paintings and Tithes: What was life like in a medieval village?			
L6: Lesson 6: 1348: How did the Black Death shatter medieval social order?			
L7: Lesson 7: 1381: Why did the Peasants revolt, and did they achieve anything?			
L8: Lesson 8: The Wars of the Roses (1455–1485) - How did the medieval era end in blood?			
L9: Lesson 9: Assessment: How powerful was a medieval monarch?			
Final Unit Grade:			

L1: Lesson 1: 1066 - Why did three men claim one throne, and how did William win?

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Explain why there was a succession crisis in 1066 and evaluate the claims of the three rivals.
- ☐ Analyze the sequence of events leading up to the Battle of Hastings.
- ☐ Evaluate the reasons for William's victory at the Battle of Hastings.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

What century are we currently studying?

Who were the native people living in England before 1066?

What was the most important building in a medieval village?

What is an heir to the throne?

Who was the English King that died in January 1066 without a clear heir?

What was the 'Witan' in Anglo-Saxon England?

Which group of people were famous for raiding England in longships?

Where is Normandy located?

What does it mean to claim the throne?

What is a power vacuum?

Vocabulary Check

Write a short paragraph using at least **FOUR** of the vocabulary words below correctly.

Witan | Claimant | Succession Crisis | Feigned Retreat | Shield Wall

Q1. The Claimants' Pitch (Group Battle) Imagine you are an adviser to the Witan (the council of English lords) in January 1066. Write a short persuasive speech (3-4 sentences) for ONE of the three claimants (Harold, William, or Hardrada) convincing the lords why they should choose your man to be King. Hint: Make sure you use their specific historical evidence (like Harold's deathbed promise, William's holy oath, or Hardrada's old Viking treaty) to make your case!

Q2. The Exhaustion Timeline (Why Timing was Everything) Historians argue that William was incredibly lucky with the weather in September 1066. 1. Calculate the days: How many days did Harold have between fighting the Vikings at Stamford Bridge (25 Sept) and fighting the Normans at Hastings (14 Oct)? 2. Explain the impact: Write a short explanation of how the timing of the two invasions left Harold's army at a massive disadvantage before the Battle of Hastings even started.

Drawing Task: Q3 Tension Timeline Draw a line graph mapping King Harold's stress levels day-by-day throughout September and October 1066. Label key events such as waiting for the wind, hearing about the Viking invasion, winning at Stamford Bridge, and the Norman landing.

Q4. Source Analysis (Source A) According to Source A, what was the main reason King Harold lost the battle? *Hint: Look at the sentence describing how William arrived at the battlefield.*

Q5. Source Analysis (Source B) Look at Source B (The Bayeux Tapestry). How does this source support the idea that Harold's death was chaotic and brutal?

Q6. Hastings Tactical Analysis (How the Battle was Won) Copy and complete the flow diagram below to show how the battle shifted in William's favour.

1. Saxon Shield Wall holds firm on the high ground



2. Rumour spreads that William is [.]. William removes his [.] to prove he is alive.



3. The Cunning Plan: William orders a "[.] retreat" to trick the Saxons down the hill.



4. Saxon Shield Wall is broken. Archers fire [.], and King [.] is killed.

Q8 Put these key events of 1066 in the correct chronological order to map out the dramatic sequence of events.

- ☐ Edward the Confessor dies without a direct heir.
- ☐ Harold Godwinson is crowned King of England.
- ☐ Harald Hardrada and the Vikings invade the north of England.
- ☐ Harold Godwinson marches north and defeats the Vikings at Stamford Bridge.
- ☐ The wind changes, allowing William's Norman fleet to cross the English Channel.
- ☐ The English army rushes south but is defeated by the Normans at the Battle of Hastings.

Pair & Share Activity

Q9. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: Which of the three claimants do you think had the strongest legal claim to the throne of England, and why?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

Lesson Consolidation

Reflect on today's learning and answer your teacher's final challenge.

General Notes

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Teacher Comment:

L2: Lesson 2: Castles, Terror, and the Domesday Book - How did William control England?

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand how the motte and bailey castle design allowed Normans to quickly establish military dominance.
- ☐ Evaluate the causes and devastating consequences of the Harrying of the North.
- ☐ Analyze the purpose and impact of the Domesday Book using local Hampshire records.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

Which powerful English Earl claimed the throne because of a deathbed promise?

Which Viking warrior claimed the throne based on an old treaty?

Who claimed the throne because of a broken oath sworn on holy relics?

Where did King Harold march his army to fight the Vikings?

Who won the Battle of Stamford Bridge?

Why was Harold's army exhausted before fighting William?

Where did William the Conqueror's army land in England?

Who supported William's invasion, making it a religious crusade?

What was the name of the battle between Harold and William?

In what year did all these three battles take place?

Vocabulary Check

Write a historically accurate sentence connecting two terms from the glossary box below.

Motte | Bailey | Palisade | Harrying | Domesday Book | Shire | Tenant-in-chief

Your Sentence:

Drawing Task: Q1 Sketch a Motte and Bailey castle and label the key defensive features (Motte, Keep, Bailey, Palisade, Ditch).

Q2. Task: Look at Source B (Portchester Castle). Why would this towering stone keep be absolutely terrifying for the local English peasants who lived in small wooden huts?

Q3. Explain why William carried out the Harrying of the North and what the consequences were for the people living in the region.

[illegible]

Q4. Create a flow diagram tracking how the Domesday survey was carried out from 1085 to 1086.

Q5. Look at the visual image of the Domesday Book in the Key Individuals section. Why was having all of this information written down in a permanent book so terrifying for the English population?

Q6. Local History Investigation. Look at the Domesday records for our local area. Explain what resources were recorded in Fareham and what this reveals about how Norman control impacted our local community.

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Q8. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: Did William conquer England using fear, or using organisation? Which was more important?

Your Notes:

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Teacher Comment:

L3: Lesson 3: Crown vs Church: Why did Henry II clash with Thomas Becket?

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand Henry II's motives for appointing Thomas Becket as Archbishop of Canterbury.
- ☐ Evaluate the reasons for the complete breakdown in relations between Henry and Becket.
- ☐ Analyze the events of the murder in 1170 and its aftermath.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

Who won the Battle of Hastings to become King of England?

What type of castles did the Normans first build to control England rapidly?

What was the 'motte'?

What brutal tactic did William use to destroy northern rebellions?

What was the purpose of the Domesday Book (1086)?

Who was the Viking claimant killed at Stamford Bridge?

What material were the first Norman castles made from?

What was the 'bailey' in a castle?

What does 'feudalism' mean?

How many people died of starvation due to the Harrying of the North?

Vocabulary Check

Write a clear definition and a historically accurate sentence for the term: **Common Law**

Q1. Explain why Henry II chose to appoint Thomas Becket as Archbishop of Canterbury in 1162, and explain why this appointment backfired.

Q2. Explain the main reasons why the relationship between King Henry II and Archbishop Thomas Becket broke down completely between 1162 and 1164.

Q3Task 3: Source Inference (Source C) Look at Source C. Make two inferences about how the monk who witnessed the murder viewed the knights who killed Thomas Becket. Support each inference with a detail from the source.

Q4.

Pair & Share Activity

Q5. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: If you were King Henry II, would you have appointed your best friend as Archbishop, or a deeply religious monk?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

Lesson Consolidation

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Teacher Comment:

L4: Lesson 4: Magna Carta (1215): A triumph of liberty or a selfish baronial power grab?

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand the multiple reasons for the barons' anger towards King John by 1215.
- ☐ Analyze the key clauses of Magna Carta and how they limited absolute royal power.
- ☐ Evaluate whether Magna Carta was a triumph of liberty or a selfish baronial power grab.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

Which king introduced common law and royal courts in 1154?

Who did Henry II appoint as Archbishop of Canterbury?

Why did Henry and Becket clash?

What happened to Thomas Becket in 1170?

What did the Pope do to Henry II as punishment?

Who won the Battle of Hastings?

What was the Domesday Book?

What is a 'criminous clerk'?

Why did Henry II walk barefoot through Canterbury being whipped?

What is a motte and bailey?

Vocabulary Check

Write a short paragraph using at least *FOUR* of the vocabulary words below correctly.

Angevin Empire | Scutage | Papal Interdict | Magna Carta | Clause 39 | Habeas Corpus

Q1 King John was a disastrous ruler. Match his failures to the correct category.

Losing all his land in Normandy to the French King Philip II	• •	Military Failure
Arguing with the Pope and getting excommunicated	• •	Religious Dispute
Raising the Scutage tax on his barons again and again	• •	Financial Extortion

Q2. The Baron's Lawyer. Magna Carta contained 63 clauses. Below are three of the most famous. Categorize them into 'Financial', 'Legal', or 'Royal Power' limitations: 1. 'No freeman shall be arrested or imprisoned without a fair trial.' 2. 'No scutage (tax) shall be imposed without the general consent of the realm.' 3. 'The English Church shall be free from royal interference.'

Q3. The Trial of King John (Interpretation) Divide your answer into two parts: 1. You are King John's defense lawyer. Write a short paragraph defending his actions, explaining why the heavy taxes were necessary. 2. Now, act as the Barons' prosecutor. Write a response arguing why his actions were tyrannical and justified the Magna Carta.

[illegible]

Pair & Share Activity

Q4. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: Do you think the Magna Carta was about freedom for all people, or just the barons protecting their own wealth?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

Your Notes:

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[illegible]

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Teacher Comment:

L5: Lesson 5: Doom Paintings and Tithes: What was life like in a medieval village?

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

☐ Understand the daily agricultural routine and living conditions of a medieval villein.

☐ Explain how the Catholic Church maintained absolute control over peasant life.

Vocabulary Check

Write a historically accurate sentence connecting two terms from the glossary box below.

Villein | Tithe | Doom Painting | Purgatory | Harvest

Your Sentence:

Q1. Explain why the parish church was the most important building in a medieval village, referencing both its religious and community uses.

Q2. Task: Look at Source A (The Medieval Church Interior). List three different activities taking place in the church other than praying.

Q3. Task: Look at Source A (the medieval parish church). Identify three different activities taking place inside the church, showing that it was used for more than just praying.

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Pair & Share Activity

Q7. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: Why was the Church able to take a tenth (tithe) of a peasant's crops when they were already starving?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

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Teacher Comment:

L6: Lesson 6: 1348: How did the Black Death shatter medieval social order?

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand why the medieval population was medically and socially defenseless against the Black Death in 1348.
- ☐ Explain how the severe labor shortage shifted economic power from the nobility to the peasantry.
- ☐ Analyze the long-term structural and psychological breakdown of the feudal system.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

Which king lost Normandy and Aquitaine to the French?

What mocking nickname was given to King John?

Why were the barons angry with King John?

What document was King John forced to seal in 1215?

What was the most important principle of Magna Carta?

Where was Thomas Becket murdered?

What does 'excommunication' mean?

Who built the first motte and bailey castles in England?

What was the Harrying of the North?

What did Henry II want to stop Church courts from doing?

Vocabulary Check

Write a clear definition and a historically accurate sentence for the term: **Bubonic Plague**

Q1 The Plague Doctor. Play the role of a medieval physician and try to cure the infected patients.

Read the patient symptoms below. Write down your recommended medieval cure in the empty box. Your teacher will reveal the outcome!

Patient	Symptoms	Your Recommended Cure
William	High fever, shivering, and large, painful black swellings (buboes) in his armpits.	
Agnes	Coughing up blood, severe chest pain, and struggling to breathe.	
John	Fingers and toes have turned completely black. High fever and vomiting.	
Thomas	A runny nose, a mild cough, and feeling a bit tired.	

Q2. Explain how the Black Death transformed the balance of economic power between lords and peasants after 1348.

[illegible]

Q3. The Plague Doctor's Diary (Empathetic Writing) Write a diary entry as a physician in 1348. Explain the horrifying symptoms you are witnessing in your patients, the 'cures' you are attempting to use (such as bloodletting or carrying sweet-smelling herbs), and why you believe they are failing due to your lack of germ theory.

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Pair & Share Activity

Q4. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: If you were a peasant who survived the Black Death, how would your attitude towards the local lord and the Church change?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

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Teacher Comment:

L7: Lesson 7: 1381: Why did the Peasants revolt, and did they achieve anything?

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Identify the long-term economic and short-term political causes of the Peasants' Revolt.
- ☐ Analyze the extent of the threat posed by the rebels when they captured London.
- ☐ Evaluate the immediate outcome and long-term consequences of the revolt.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

In what year did the Black Death arrive in England?

What fraction of the English population was killed by the plague?

What were 'buboes'?

Why couldn't medieval doctors cure the plague?

What supernatural reason did people blame for the plague?

What document limited King John's power in 1215?

Who was murdered by four knights in 1170?

Why did King John charge heavy 'scutage' taxes?

What was the Domesday Book used for?

Who won the Battle of Stamford Bridge in 1066?

Vocabulary Check

Write a short paragraph using at least **FOUR** of the vocabulary words below correctly.

Poll Tax | John Ball | Wat Tyler | Simon Sudbury | Smithfield | Manorial Rolls

Q1.

Q2. How much of a threat did the rebels actually pose to King Richard II and royal government when they seized London in June 1381?

Q3. Create a 5-step chronological flow diagram showing the key events of the Peasants' Revolt from the initial march on London to the execution of the rebel leaders.

Pair & Share Activity

Q4. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: Did the Peasants' Revolt achieve anything, or was it a complete failure?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

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Teacher Comment:

L8: Lesson 8: The Wars of the Roses (1455–1485) - How did the medieval era end in blood?

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Explain the causes of the Wars of the Roses and the division between Lancaster and York.
- ☐ Understand the significance of the Battle of Bosworth in ending the medieval era.

Vocabulary Check

Write a historically accurate sentence connecting two terms from the glossary box below.

Dynasty | House of Lancaster | House of York | Usurp | Tudor

Your Sentence:

Q1. Explain what caused the Wars of the Roses to break out in 1455, and describe how this instability affected the English monarchy over the next thirty years.

Q2. Task: Look at Sources A and B. Why was it important for rival noble houses to have simple, recognizable badges like the Red and White Roses during a chaotic civil war?

Q3. Create a 5-step chronological flow diagram showing the key events of the Battle of Bosworth Field, from the arrival of the two armies to the crowning of the first Tudor king.

Pair & Share Activity

Q4. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: Discuss the main topic of this lesson.

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

Lesson Consolidation

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Teacher Comment:

L9: Lesson 9: Assessment: How powerful was a medieval monarch?

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ To accurately sequence the key events of the medieval period.
- ☐ To evaluate differing historical interpretations of medieval royal power.
- ☐ To write a structured essay explaining the decline of royal power.

Chronological Domino Flowchart

Score: / 5

Task: The historical events below are out of order. Read them carefully, then use your pen to **draw arrows connecting the boxes** in the correct chronological and causal order (Event A → Event B → Event C...).

1381

The Peasants' Revolt

Peasants rebel against the Poll Tax and demand the end of serfdom.

1066

The Norman Conquest

William the Conqueror defeats Harold Godwinson and unleashes the Harrying of the North.

1086

The Domesday Book

A massive survey to assess the wealth of the country for taxation.

1170

Murder of Thomas Becket

The Archbishop of Canterbury is murdered by knights loyal to Henry II.

1215

Magna Carta

King John is forced by his barons to seal the Great Charter, limiting royal power.

1348

The Black Death

The bubonic plague arrives in England, killing a third of the population.

Vocabulary Check

Write a clear definition and a historically accurate sentence for the term: **Feudalism**

Q1. Which of the two interpretations do you find more convincing? Explain your answer using your own knowledge.

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Explain why royal power weakened between 1066 and 1485 (12 marks)

Hints:

- Start with a clear introduction stating that while royal power was initially strong under William I, it was weakened by the Church, angry barons, and eventually the peasants.
- Use your first paragraph to explain how Magna Carta limited the King's power in 1215.
- Use your second paragraph to explain how the Peasants' Revolt (1381) and the Wars of the Roses (1455-1485) challenged the Crown's stability.

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